US 20250273040A1

(19) United States

(12) Patent Application Publication

(10) Pub. No.: US 2025/0273040 A1

FROY et al.

(43) Pub. Date: Aug. 28, 2025

(54) **CROSS-CHANNEL WAGERING GAME TOURNAMENTS**

(71) Applicant: **IGT**, Las Vegas, NV (US)

(72) Inventors: **David FROY**, Lakeville-Westmorland (CA); **Gaurav JARIWALA**, Halifax (CA); **Fayez IDRIS**, Dieppe (CA); **Karen VAN NIEKERK**, Dieppe (CA); **Bethany PLIMMER**, Lower Coverdale (CA); **David SMALL**, Moncton (CA); **Todd GRIMM**, Riverview (CA); **Michael RUSS**, Graz (AT)

(73) Assignee: **IGT**, Las Vegas, NV (US)

(21) Appl. No.: **18/587,810**

(22) Filed: **Feb. 26, 2024**

Publication Classification

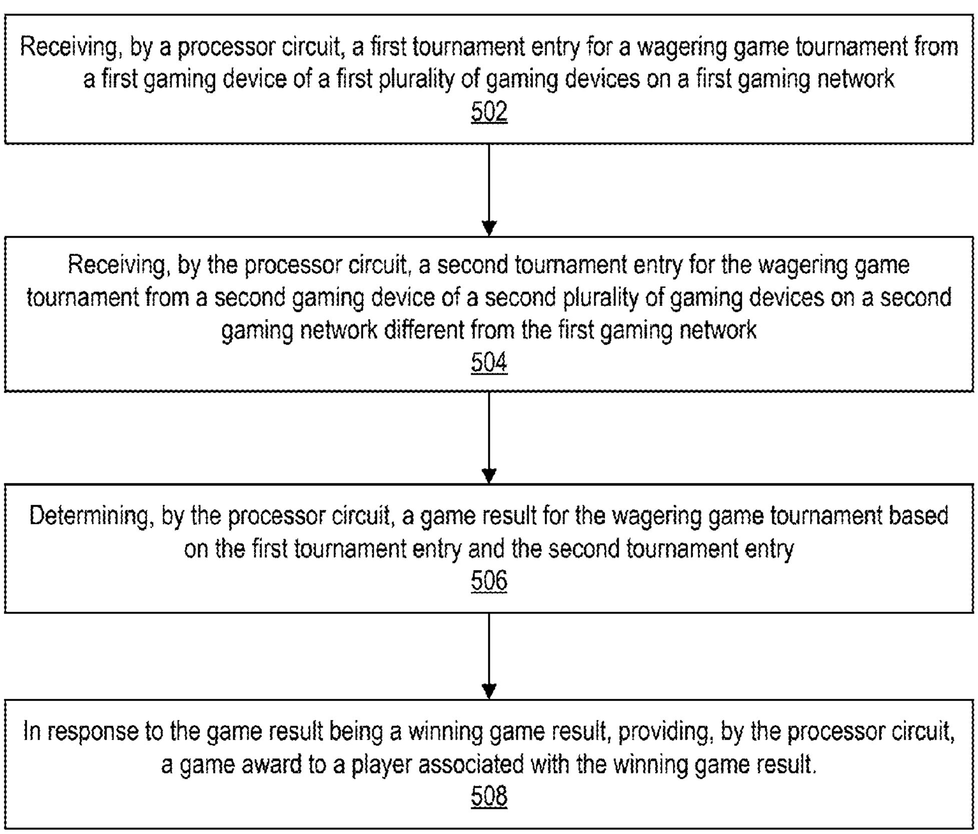
(51) **Int. Cl.**
G07F 17/32 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC ***G07F 17/3225*** (2013.01); ***G07F 17/3267*** (2013.01); ***G07F 17/3276*** (2013.01)

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A system includes a processor circuit and a memory coupled to the processor circuit. The memory includes machine-readable instructions that cause the processor circuit to receive a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to receive a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network. A game result is determined for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry and, in response to the game result being a winning game result, a game award is provided to a player associated with the winning game result.

500



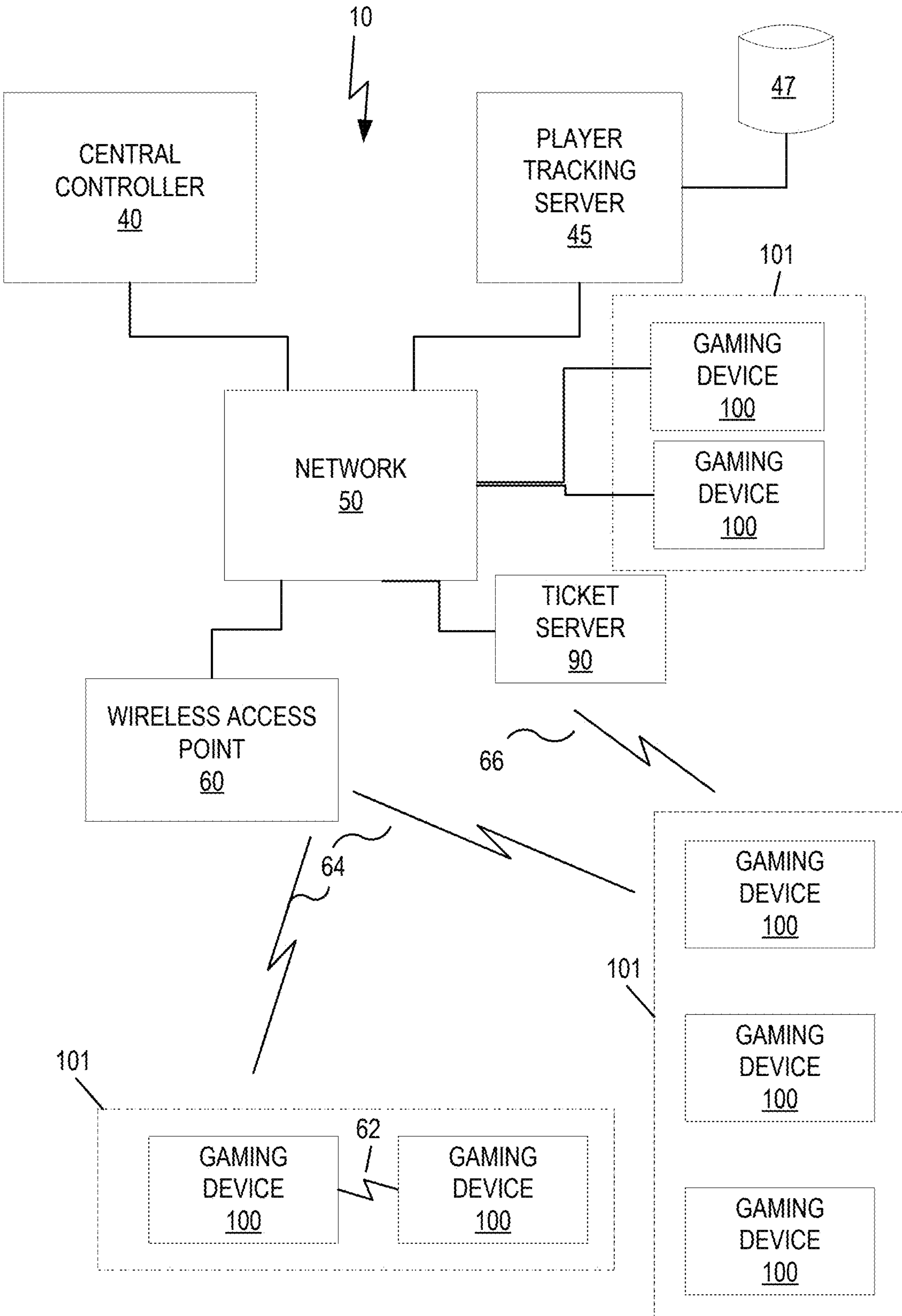

10
CENTRAL CONTROLLER 40
PLAYER TRACKING SERVER 45
47
101
GAMING DEVICE 100
GAMING DEVICE 100
NETWORK 50
TICKET SERVER 90
WIRELESS ACCESS POINT 60
66
64
GAMING DEVICE 100
101
GAMING DEVICE 100
101
62
GAMING DEVICE 100
GAMING DEVICE 100
GAMING DEVICE 100

FIG. 1

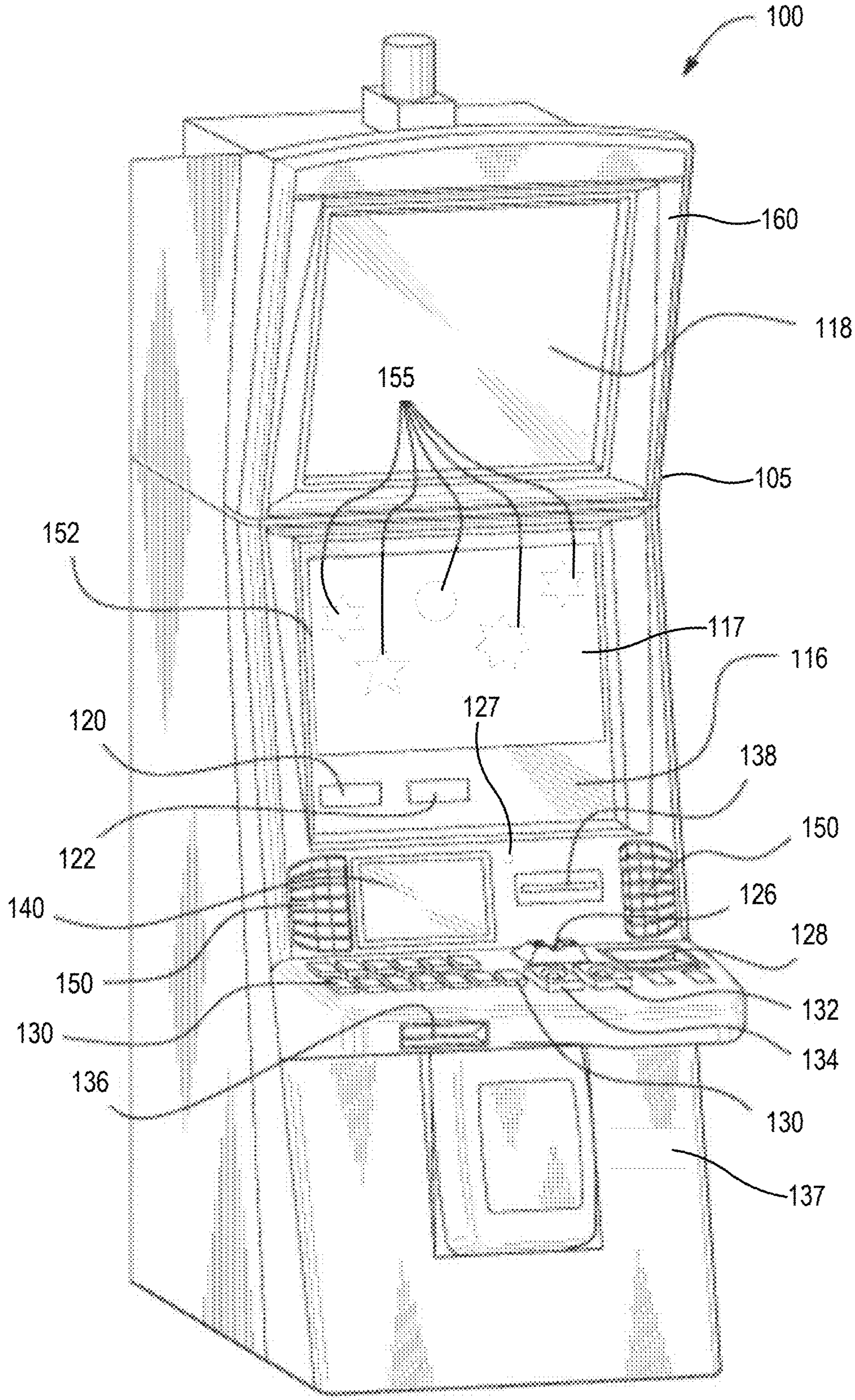
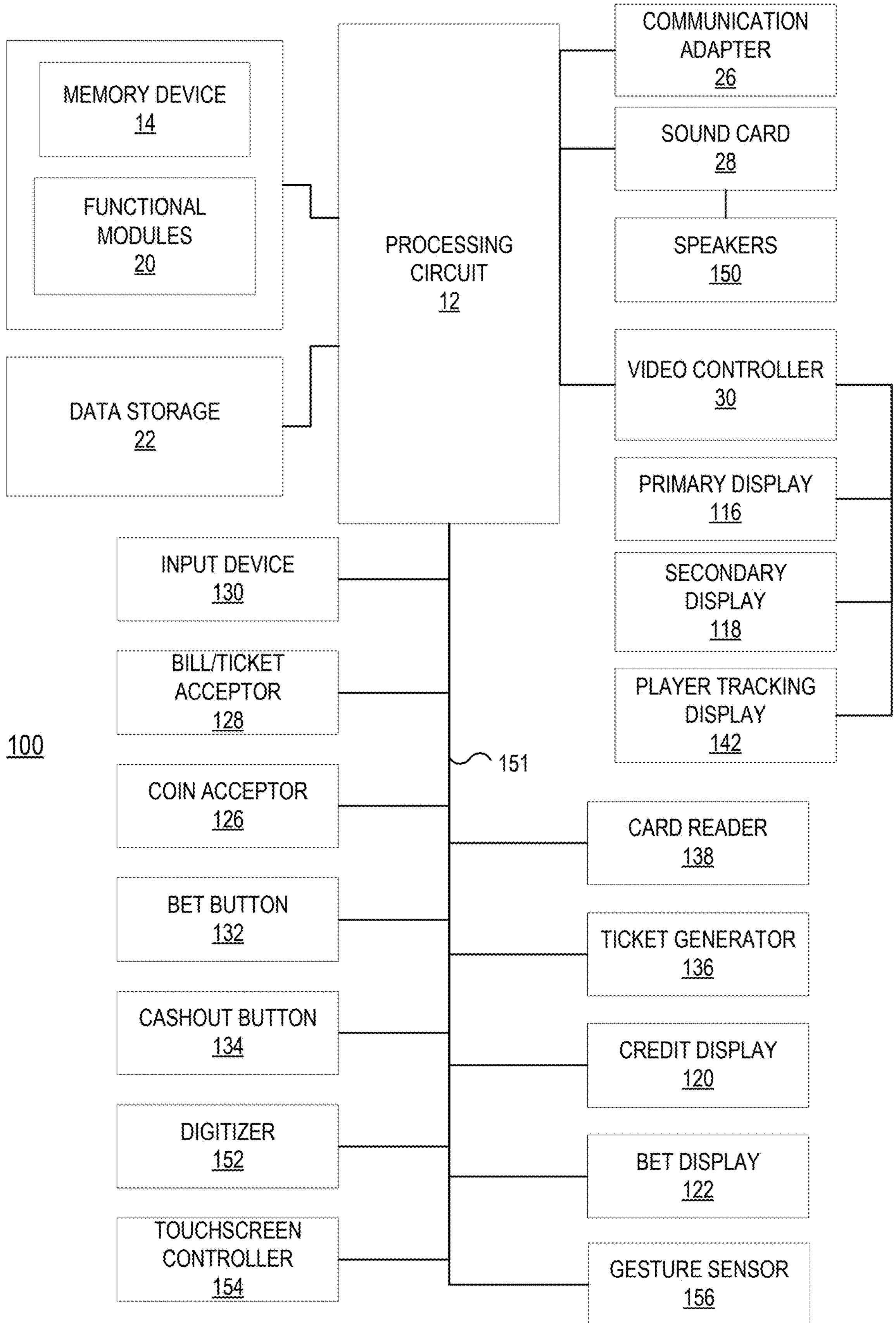

100
160
118
155
105
152
117
116
127
120
138
150
122
140
126
128
150
132
130
134
136
130
137

FIG. 2A



MEMORY DEVICE
14
FUNCTIONAL MODULES
20
DATA STORAGE
22
PROCESSING CIRCUIT
12
COMMUNICATION ADAPTER
26
SOUND CARD
28
SPEAKERS
150
VIDEO CONTROLLER
30
PRIMARY DISPLAY
116
SECONDARY DISPLAY
118
PLAYER TRACKING DISPLAY
142
INPUT DEVICE
130
BILL/TICKET ACCEPTOR
128
100
COIN ACCEPTOR
126
151
CARD READER
138
BET BUTTON
132
TICKET GENERATOR
136
CASHOUT BUTTON
134
CREDIT DISPLAY
120
DIGITIZER
152
BET DISPLAY
122
TOUCHSCREEN CONTROLLER
154
GESTURE SENSOR
156

FIG. 2B

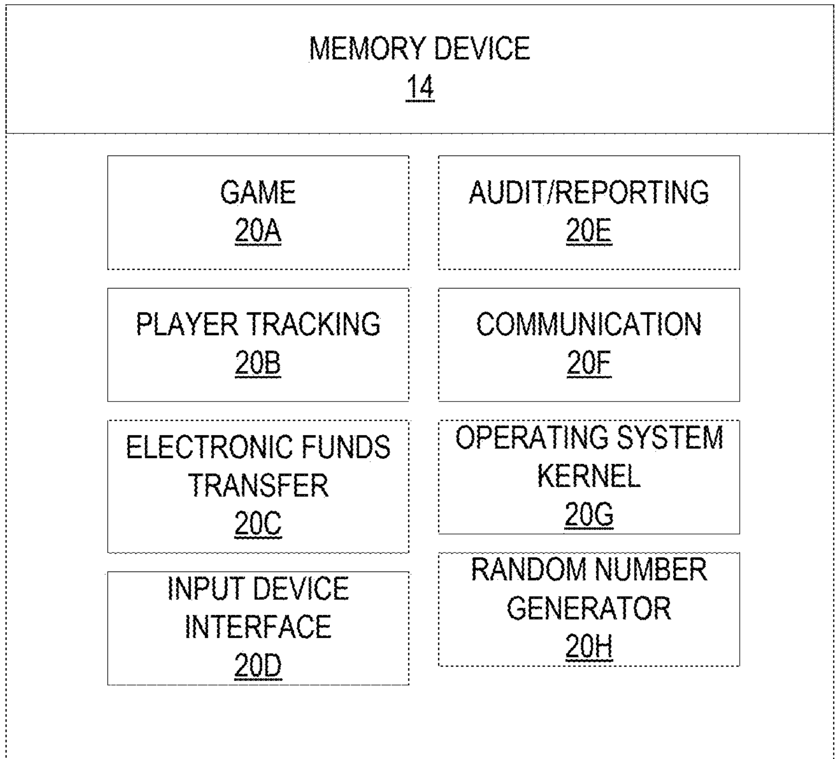

MEMORY DEVICE
14
GAME
20A
AUDIT/REPORTING
20E
PLAYER TRACKING
20B
COMMUNICATION
20F
ELECTRONIC FUNDS TRANSFER
20C
OPERATING SYSTEM KERNEL
20G
INPUT DEVICE INTERFACE
20D
RANDOM NUMBER GENERATOR
20H

FIG. 2C

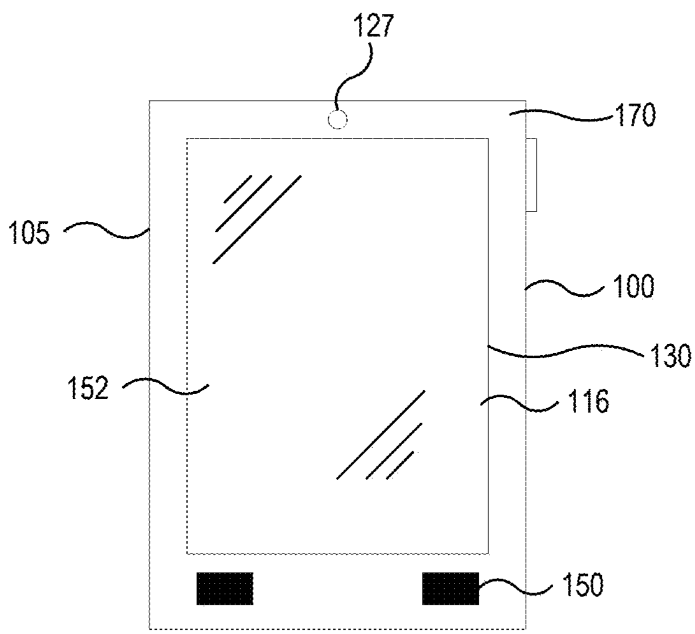

127
170
105
100
130
152
116
150

FIG. 2D

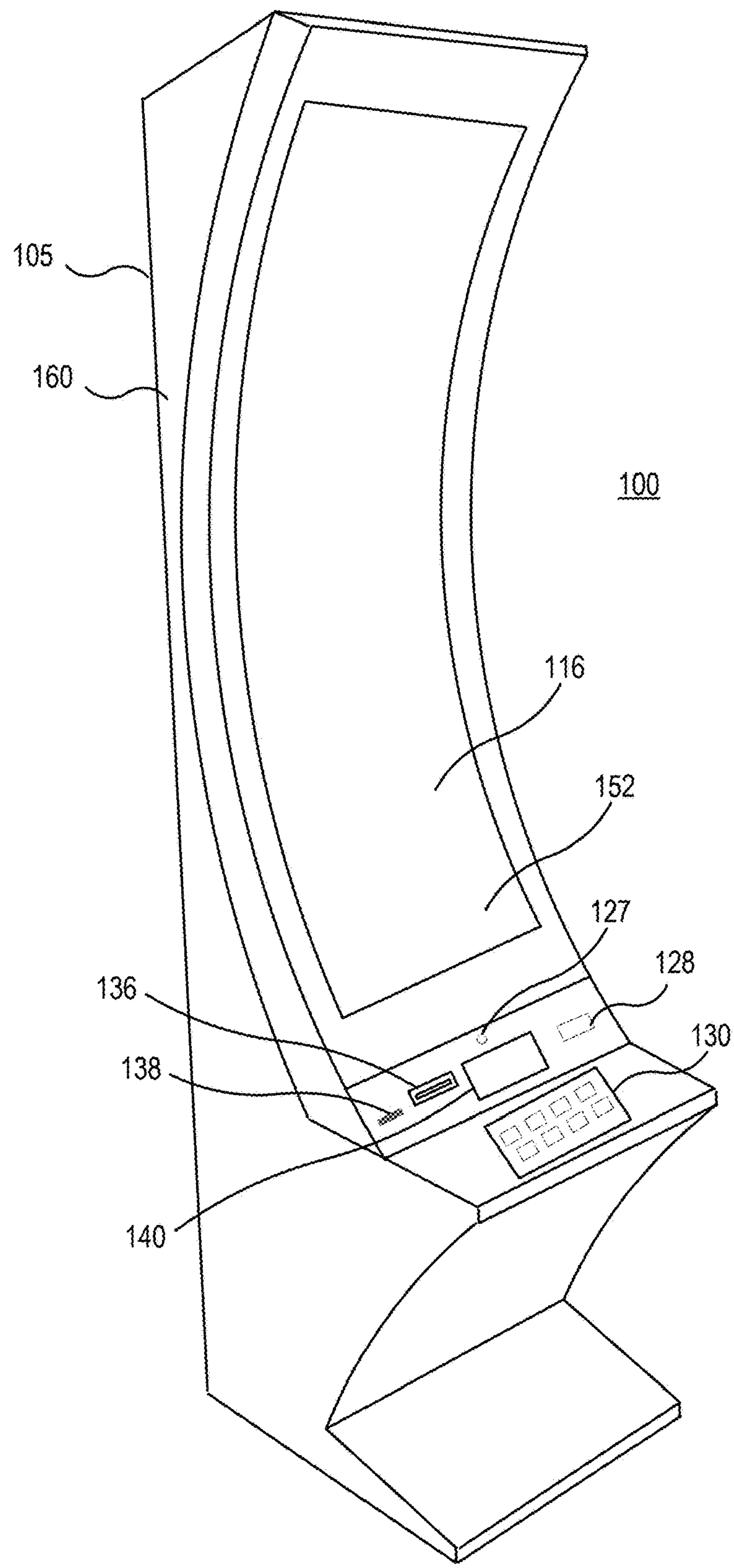


FIG. 2E

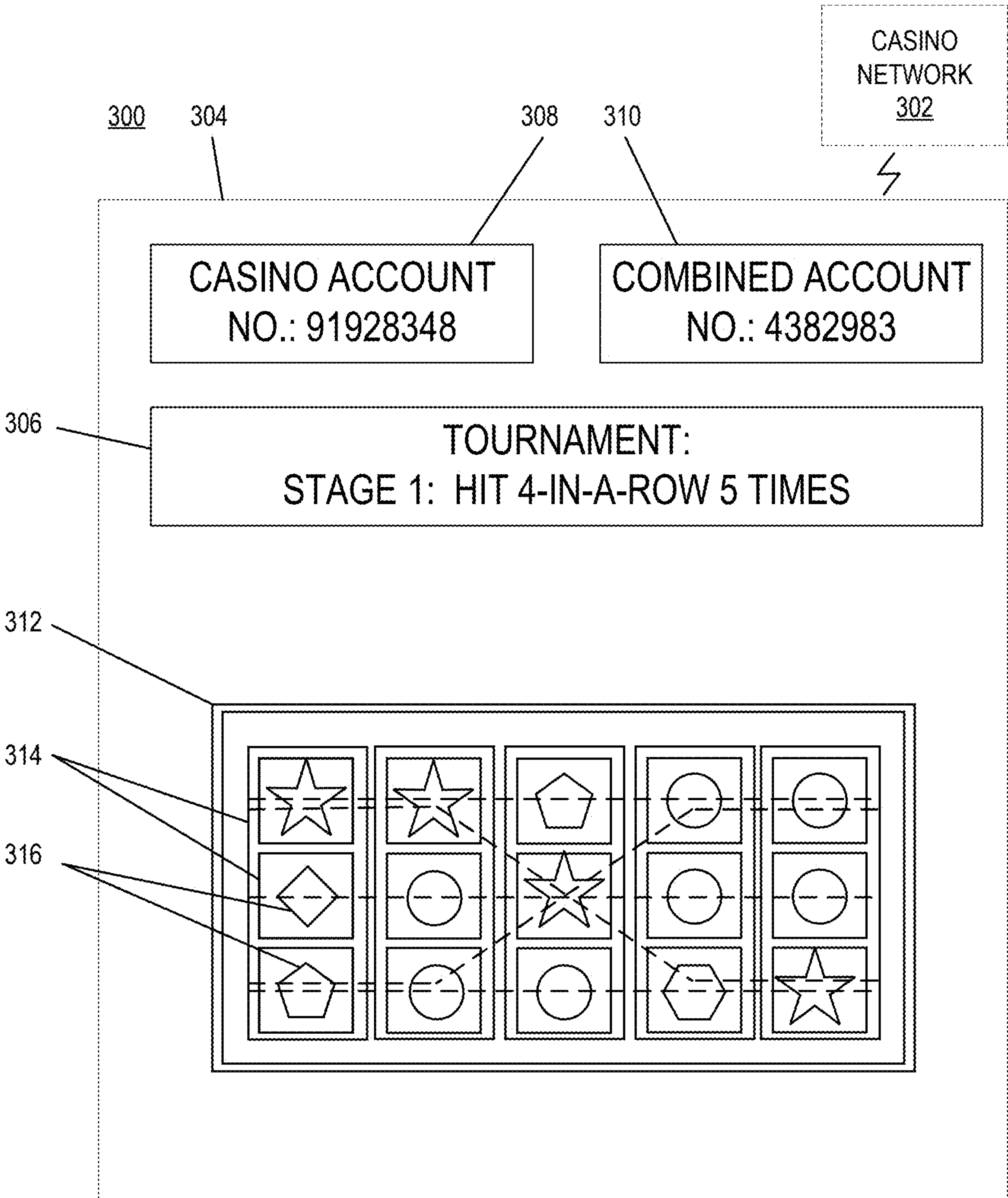

CASINO NETWORK 302
300
304
308
310
CASINO ACCOUNT NO.: 91928348
COMBINED ACCOUNT NO.: 4382983
306
TOURNAMENT: STAGE 1: HIT 4-IN-A-ROW 5 TIMES
312
314
316

FIG. 3A

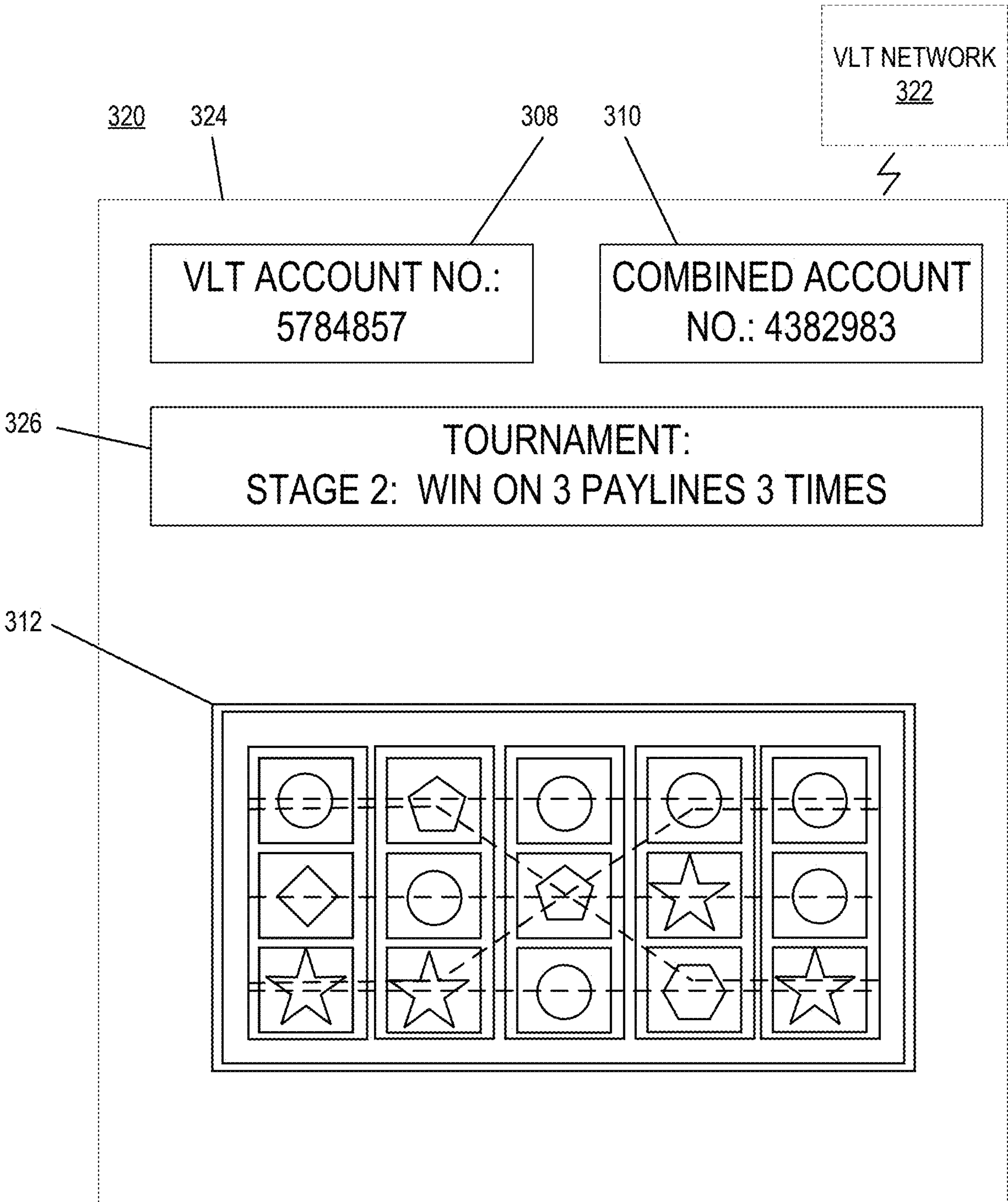

VLT NETWORK
322
320
324
308
310
VLT ACCOUNT NO.: 5784857
COMBINED ACCOUNT NO.: 4382983
326
TOURNAMENT:
STAGE 2: WIN ON 3 PAYLINES 3 TIMES
312

FIG. 3B

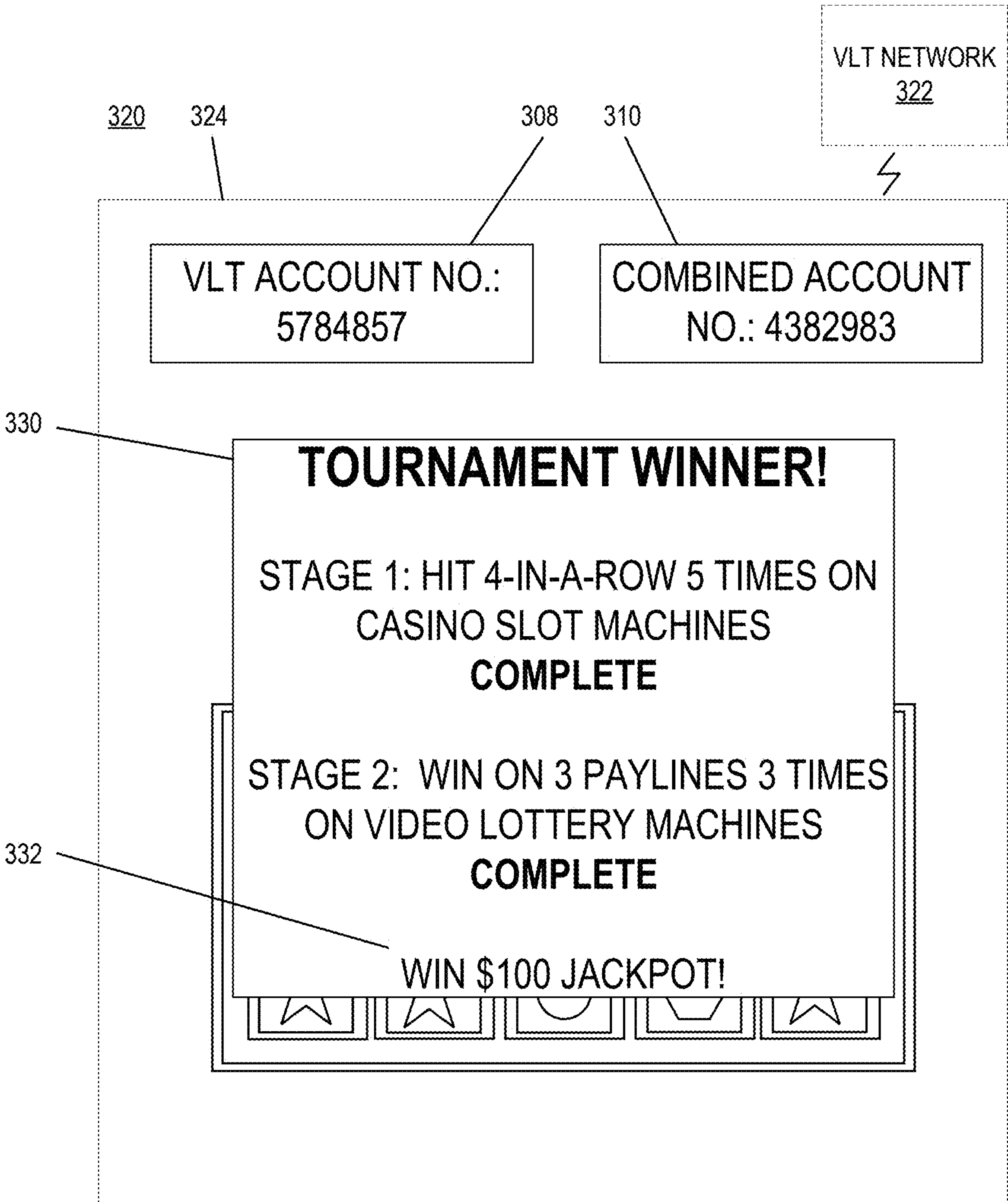

VLT NETWORK
322
320
324
308
310
VLT ACCOUNT NO.: 5784857
COMBINED ACCOUNT NO.: 4382983
330
TOURNAMENT WINNER!
STAGE 1: HIT 4-IN-A-ROW 5 TIMES ON CASINO SLOT MACHINES
COMPLETE
STAGE 2: WIN ON 3 PAYLINES 3 TIMES ON VIDEO LOTTERY MACHINES
COMPLETE
332
WIN $100 JACKPOT!

FIG. 3C

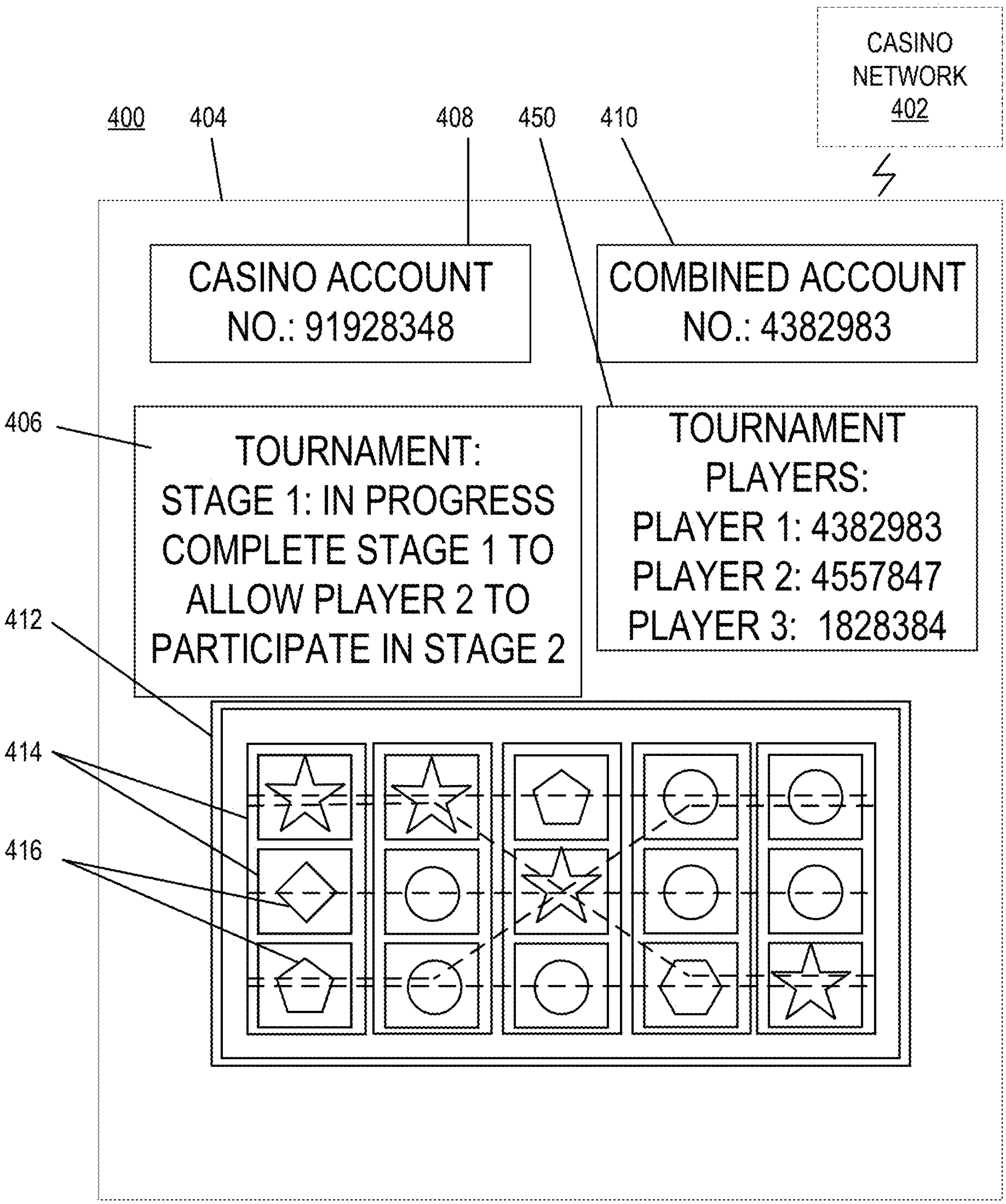

CASINO NETWORK 402
400
404
408
450
410
CASINO ACCOUNT NO.: 91928348
COMBINED ACCOUNT NO.: 4382983
406
TOURNAMENT:
STAGE 1: IN PROGRESS
COMPLETE STAGE 1 TO ALLOW PLAYER 2 TO PARTICIPATE IN STAGE 2
TOURNAMENT PLAYERS:
PLAYER 1: 4382983
PLAYER 2: 4557847
PLAYER 3: 1828384
412
414
416

FIG. 4A

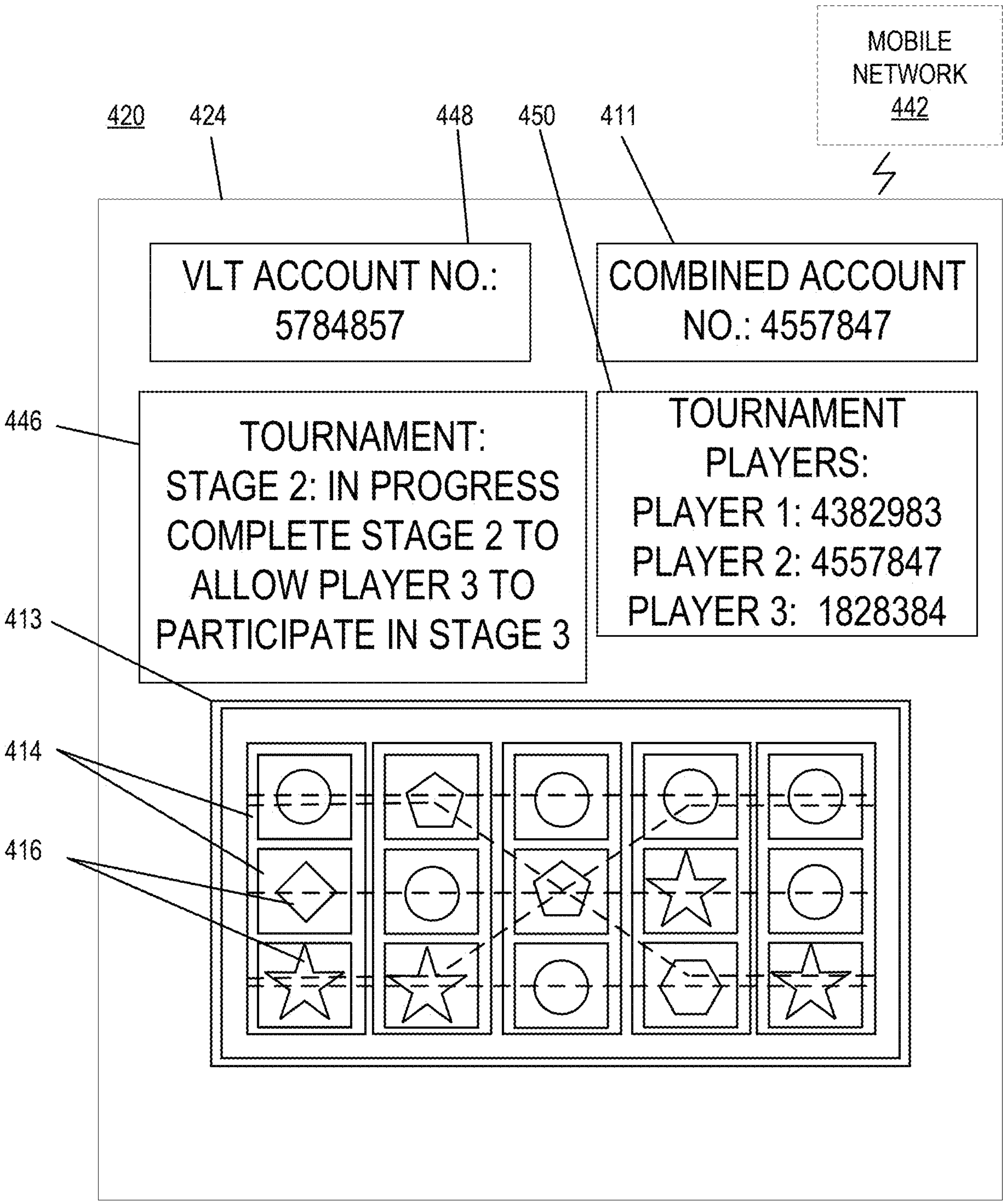

MOBILE
NETWORK
442
420
424
448
450
411
VLT ACCOUNT NO.:
5784857
COMBINED ACCOUNT
NO.: 4557847
446
TOURNAMENT:
STAGE 2: IN PROGRESS
COMPLETE STAGE 2 TO
ALLOW PLAYER 3 TO
PARTICIPATE IN STAGE 3
TOURNAMENT
PLAYERS:
PLAYER 1: 4382983
PLAYER 2: 4557847
PLAYER 3: 1828384
413
414
416

FIG. 4B

500

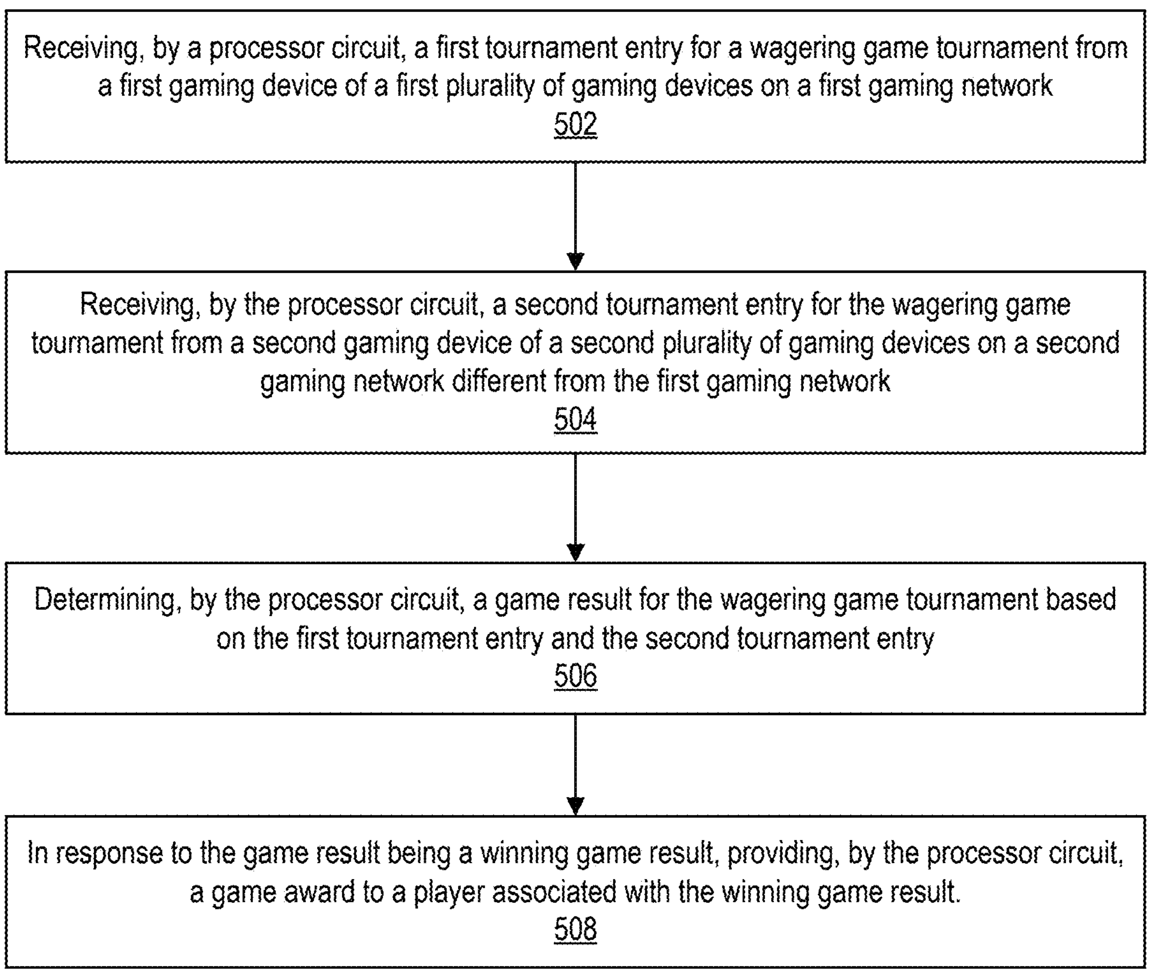

Receiving, by a processor circuit, a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network
502
Receiving, by the processor circuit, a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network
504
Determining, by the processor circuit, a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry
506
In response to the game result being a winning game result, providing, by the processor circuit, a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.
508

FIG. 5

CROSS-CHANNEL WAGERING GAME TOURNAMENTS

BACKGROUND

[0001] Embodiments described herein relate to wagering game tournaments, and in particular to providing wagering game tournaments employing multiple wagering game channels and environments, and related devices, systems, and methods. As the provision of wagering games across multiple channels, such as land-based casinos, video lottery terminals, and personal computing devices, becomes more widespread, the markets for different games and experiences are becoming more fragmented and isolated from each other. There is a need to address these and other technical problems with unique technical solutions that to provide a more integrated, familiar, and consistent experience for users across different channels to increase and enhance enjoyment.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0002] According to some embodiments, a system includes a processor circuit and a memory coupled to the processor circuit. The memory includes machine-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor circuit, cause the processor circuit to receive a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to receive a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to determine a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to, in response to the game result being a winning game result, provide a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

[0003] According to some embodiments, a system includes a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network, a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network, a processor circuit, and a memory coupled to the processor circuit. The memory includes machine-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor circuit, cause the processor circuit to receive a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of the first plurality of gaming devices. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to receive a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of the second plurality of gaming devices. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to determine a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry. The instructions further cause the processor circuit to, in response to the game result being a winning game result, provide a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

[0004] According to some embodiments, a method includes receiving, by a processor circuit, a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network. The method further includes receiving, by the processor circuit, a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network. The method further includes determining, by the processor circuit, a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry. The method further includes, in response to the game result being a winning game result, providing, by the processor circuit, a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0005] FIG. **1** is a schematic block diagram illustrating a network configuration for a plurality of gaming devices according to some embodiments.

[0006] FIG. **2**A is a perspective view of a gaming device that can be configured according to some embodiments.

[0007] FIG. **2**B is a schematic block diagram illustrating an electronic configuration for a gaming device according to some embodiments.

[0008] FIG. **2**C is a schematic block diagram that illustrates various functional modules of a gaming device according to some embodiments.

[0009] FIG. **2**D is perspective view of a gaming device that can be configured according to some embodiments.

[0010] FIG. **2**E is a perspective view of a gaming device according to further embodiments.

[0011] FIGS. **3**A-**3**C illustrate a wagering game tournament being played by a player across different devices and platforms, according to some embodiments.

[0012] FIGS. **4**A and **4**B illustrate a wagering game tournament being played by different players across different devices and platforms, according to some embodiments.

[0013] FIG. **5** is a flowchart illustrating operations of systems/methods for facilitating embodiments described herein, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0014] Embodiments described herein relate to a shared virtual gaming environment, and in particular to providing a continuous game session between a real world gaming environment and a shared virtual gaming environment, and related devices, systems, and methods. In some embodiments, players in different locations may participate in tournaments together, across different gaming networks and/or channels (e.g., casino slot networks, video lottery terminal (VLT) networks, Internet, etc.). Tournaments may be single-player or team tournaments, which may be composed selectively (e.g., with players self-selecting friends or other group members), or randomly. Teams may compete against each other or collaborate, and may also compete against other teams.

[0015] Conventional gaming tournaments may be played online or locally (e.g., in a casino), but there is no mechanism for allowing players to play the same tournament across different channels. In some embodiments, an omnichannel tournament controller, which may be a network-connected server for hosting tournament play, may allow a tournament to be controlled and played by players at different locations, devices, networks, and/or channels. In some embodiments, the controller may also provide bonus games and/or awards, such as simultaneously trigger a community bonus across channels, providing a shared progressive, etc. In some embodiments, player progress and other information can be recorded and shared across different channels, such as by a shared user account connected to individual user accounts for different channels. Such information may be used to determine tournament eligibility, which may allow a player who would be ineligible based on progress on different individual channels to be eligible based on combined progress across multiple channels. A player that is invited to and/or unlocks a tournament entry may obtain a flag or other indicator in a shared player account, which can be used to indicate tournament eligibility on a different device, network, and/or channel at a later time.

[0016] Tournaments are good marketing tools for casinos and other venues, and are enjoyable attractive features for players. Embodiments described herein may allow venues to attract players from different player segments that may not participate in traditional destination-based gaming environments, and may encourage future play in different gaming channels.

[0017] In some examples, a player starts playing on one channel, such as a land based Electronic Gaming Machine (EGM) in a casino environment, a VLT environment, or on a personal computer or mobile device, which may unlock a subsequent level on a different channel. As players advance through different levels, larger jackpots may be unlocked. An omni-channel tournament could be organized in which players from different channels and different locations can participate in the same tournament, which may, in turn, attract attention as being more convenient for people to participate in competitions from a larger number and variety of devices and locations. In some examples, players can participate in these tournaments at specific times, during times of online connectivity, and/or selectively, such as using a tournament ID code or selecting a tournament option from an EGM, VLT, mobile device, etc.

[0018] Omni-channel tournaments may also be played with teams, which may be formed randomly or semi-randomly from different pools of players on the same or different server, location, region, and/or network. In some examples, a common progressive pot may be shared between the competing teams, with the winning team winning the pot. In some examples, the tournament may be based on each member of the team playing and winning on a different channel. In some examples, a relay tournament may allow a player winning on one channel to unlock the ability for the player or another player to play on another channel.

[0019] In some examples, tournament results and eligibility for different players can be tracked in a shared user account across all channels. The shared user account can be accessed from different type of devices as well as different channels. The shared user account may track a player's profile, access to various unlocked tournaments, information about associations such as possible pools that the player belongs to for shared experiences (such as friends, clans, guilds, etc.), play history, tournament placements, and/or player preferences, etc.

[0020] The omni-channel tournament controller and/or other devices in the system may communicate with devices on different channels via one or more wired or wireless network connections, e.g., using one or more network protocols to communicate with the various devices to coordinate the status of the game and progress of the player(s). The system may also support registering devices with a player's shared user account, creating and modifying user accounts, and/or setting and changing player preferences.

[0021] The omni-channel tournament controller and/or other devices in the system may also host and coordinate tournaments with user devices in different channels connected to the system. In some examples, a tournament can be started automatically or manually by an administrator or tournament manager. For example, after a tournament is set up and triggered, players may be invited to join the tournament through a notification system. After the players confirm that they are logged in and ready, the tournament may count down and begin. The system may send tournament status and user placement to user devices periodically during and after the tournament, to provide progress and results for the tournament to the different devices.

[0022] In some examples, cross-channel tournaments may include exclusive times, features, and/or awards for participating players, such as enabling tournament access from different channels for different players. In some examples, a bonus functionality may allow players to work together across channels toward a bonus award, such as at a predetermined time or triggered by a number of players playing at one time across different channels, e.g., with a minimum number of players on a minimum number of channels at one time, or with each player playing on a minimum number of channels during a predetermined time period. In some examples, the ability to play on different or specific channels may be provided as a perk, e.g., as a game award or loyalty bonus. For example, a player may participate in a tournament at a casino EGM and may receive a participation ticket when cashing out, which may include a code that may be scanned to register the player's participation and/or unlock the ability to continue to participate in the tournament on a different channel, which may be selected automatically or by the player. In some examples, players may compete against each other or may play cooperatively, with all members of a team receiving awards based on individual team member wins. In some examples, team members may pool resources to play a single game session together, with wins being redistributed among the contributing team members.

[0023] In some examples, players may unlock achievements through game play across different channels, which may unlock or be exchanged for tournament access, higher awards, more attractive games, improved paytables and/or odds, and/or other benefits.

[0024] In some examples, a tournament may require each player from a team to play from a different channel, with each new channel being unlocked after another player on a different channel achieves a predetermined number of plays, wins, etc. Teams may compete against each other to complete the tournament across all available channels first to win a grand prize. Play across channels may include the same game or multiple different games. In some examples, play in a tournament may be time-shifted, such that different players may begin the same tournament at different times in different locations (e.g., time zones) and/or channels (e.g., which may have different levels of network connectivity that may make simultaneous real-time participation impractical). For example, the tournament may include a multi-day period for each player to participate. In some examples, results from other players may remain hidden until everyone has finished their instance. Once completed, there might be notifications, a win celebration, a results announcement event, etc., at which point all the players can view everyone's results. In some examples, certain rounds, e.g., initial rounds, may be time shifted, with subsequent rounds being conducted in real-time. For example, later rounds in a tournament may have fewer remaining players competing for larger awards, which may make real-time participation more attractive and less inconvenient compared to earlier rounds where a larger number of initial entrants may be playing more casually.

[0025] Before discussing these and other embodiments in greater detail, reference will be made to an example of a gaming system for implementing embodiments disclosed herein. In this regard, FIG. **1** illustrates a gaming system **10** including a plurality of gaming devices **100** in different channels **101**, such as a casino channel, a video lottery channel, an Internet-connected mobile device channel, a retail channel, etc. As discussed above, the gaming devices **100** may be one type of a variety of different types of gaming devices, such as EGMS, VLTs, mobile gaming devices, or other devices, for example. The gaming system **10** may be located, for example, on the premises of a gaming establishment, such as a casino. The gaming devices **100**, which are typically situated on a casino floor, may be in communication with each other and/or at least one central controller **40** through a data communication network **50** that may include a remote communication link. The data communication network **50** may be a private data communication network that is operated, for example, by the gaming facility that operates the gaming devices **100**. Communications over the data communication network **50** may be encrypted for security. The central controller **40** may be any suitable server or computing device which includes at least one processing circuit and at least one memory or storage device. Each gaming device **100** may include a processing circuit that transmits and receives events, messages, commands or any other suitable data or signal between the gaming device **100** and the central controller **40**. The gaming device processing circuit is operable to execute such communicated events, messages or commands in conjunction with the operation of the gaming device **100**. Moreover, the processing circuit of the central controller **40** is configured to transmit and receive events, messages, commands or any other suitable data or signal between the central controller **40** and each of the individual gaming devices **100**. In some embodiments, one or more of the functions of the central controller **40** may be performed by one or more gaming device processing circuits. Moreover, in some embodiments, one or more of the functions of one or more gaming device processing circuits as disclosed herein may be performed by the central controller **40**.

[0026] A wireless access point **60** provides wireless access to the data communication network **50**. The wireless access point **60** may be connected to the data communication network **50** as illustrated in FIG. **1**, and/or may be connected directly to the central controller **40** or another server connected to the data communication network **50**.

[0027] A player tracking server **45** may also be connected through the data communication network **50**. The player tracking server **45** may manage a player tracking account that tracks the player's gameplay and spending and/or other player preferences and customizations, manages loyalty awards for the player, manages funds deposited or advanced on behalf of the player, and other functions. Player information managed by the player tracking server **45** may be stored in a player information database **47**.

[0028] As further illustrated in FIG. **1**, the gaming system **10** may include a ticket server **90** that is configured to print and/or dispense wagering tickets. The ticket server **90** may be in communication with the central controller **40** through the data communication network **50**. Each ticket server **90** may include a processing circuit that transmits and receives events, messages, commands or any other suitable data or signal between the ticket server **90** and the central controller **40**. The ticket server **90** processing circuit may be operable to execute such communicated events, messages or commands in conjunction with the operation of the ticket server **90**. Moreover, in some embodiments, one or more of the functions of one or more ticket server **90** processing circuits as disclosed herein may be performed by the central controller **40**.

[0029] The gaming devices **100** communicate with one or more elements of the gaming system **10** to coordinate providing wagering games and other functionality. For example, in some embodiments, the gaming device **100** may communicate directly with the ticket server **90** over a wireless interface **62**, which may be a WiFi link, a Bluetooth link, a near field communications (NFC) link, etc. In other embodiments, the gaming device **100** may communicate with the data communication network **50** (and devices connected thereto, including other gaming devices **100**) over a wireless interface **64** with the wireless access point **60**. The wireless interface **64** may include a WiFi link, a Bluetooth link, an NFC link, etc. In still further embodiments, the gaming devices **100** may communicate simultaneously with both the ticket server **90** over the wireless interface **66** and the wireless access point **60** over the wireless interface **64**. Some embodiments provide that gaming devices **100** may communicate with other gaming devices over a wireless interface **64**. In these embodiments, wireless interface **62**, wireless interface **64** and wireless interface **66** may use different communication protocols and/or different communication resources, such as different frequencies, time slots, spreading codes, etc.

[0030] Embodiments herein may include different types of gaming devices. One example of a gaming device includes a gaming device **100** that can use gesture and/or touch-based inputs according to various embodiments is illustrated in FIGS. **2**A, **2**B, and **2**C in which FIG. **2**A is a perspective view of a gaming device **100** illustrating various physical features of the device, FIG. **2**B is a functional block diagram that schematically illustrates an electronic relationship of various elements of the gaming device **100**, and FIG. **2**C illustrates various functional modules that can be stored in a memory device of the gaming device **100**. The embodiments shown in FIGS. **2**A to **2**C are provided as examples for illustrative purposes only. It will be appreciated that gaming devices may come in many different shapes, sizes, layouts, form factors, and configurations, and with varying numbers and types of input and output devices, and that embodiments are not limited to the particular gaming device structures described herein.

[0031] Gaming devices **100** typically include a number of standard features, many of which are illustrated in FIGS. **2**A and **2**B. For example, referring to FIG. **2**A, a gaming device **100** (which is an EGM **160** in this embodiment) may include a support structure, housing **105** (e.g., cabinet) which provides support for a plurality of displays, inputs, outputs, controls and other features that enable a player to interact with the gaming device **100**.

[0032] The gaming device **100** illustrated in FIG. **2**A includes a number of display devices, including a primary display device **116** located in a central portion of the housing **105** and a secondary display device **118** located in an upper portion of the housing **105**. A plurality of game components **155** are displayed on a display screen **117** of the primary display device **116**. It will be appreciated that one or more of the display devices **116**, **118** may be omitted, or that the display devices **116**, **118** may be combined into a single display device. The gaming device **100** may further include a player tracking display **142**, a credit display **120**, and a bet display **122**. The credit display **120** displays a player's current number of credits, cash, account balance or the equivalent. The bet display **122** displays a player's amount wagered. Locations of these displays are merely illustrative as any of these displays may be located anywhere on the gaming device **100**.

[0033] The player tracking display **142** may be used to display a service window that allows the player to interact with, for example, their player loyalty account to obtain features, bonuses, comps, etc. In other embodiments, additional display screens may be provided beyond those illustrated in FIG. **2**A. In some embodiments, one or more of the player tracking display **142**, the credit display **120** and the bet display **122** may be displayed in one or more portions of one or more other displays that display other game related visual content. For example, one or more of the player tracking display **142**, the credit display **120** and the bet display **122** may be displayed in a picture in a picture on one or more displays.

[0034] The gaming device **100** may further include a number of input devices **130** that allow a player to provide various inputs to the gaming device **100**, either before, during or after a game has been played. The gaming device may further include a game play initiation button **132** and a cashout button **134**. The cashout button **134** is utilized to receive a cash payment or any other suitable form of payment corresponding to a quantity of remaining credits of a credit display.

[0035] In some embodiments, one or more input devices of the gaming device **100** are one or more game play activation devices that are each used to initiate a play of a game on the gaming device **100** or a sequence of events associated with the gaming device **100** following appropriate funding of the gaming device **100**. The example gaming device **100** illustrated in FIGS. **2**A and **2**B includes a game play activation device in the form of a game play initiation button **132**. It should be appreciated that, in other embodiments, the gaming device **100** begins game play automatically upon appropriate funding rather than upon utilization of the game play activation device.

[0036] In some embodiments, one or more input device **130** of the gaming device **100** may include wagering or betting functionality. For example, a maximum wagering or betting function may be provided that, when utilized, causes a maximum wager to be placed. Another such wagering or betting function is a repeat the bet device that, when utilized, causes the previously placed wager to be placed. A further such wagering or betting function is a bet one function. A bet is placed upon utilization of the bet one function. The bet is increased by one credit each time the bet one device is utilized. Upon the utilization of the bet one function, a quantity of credits shown in a credit display (as described below) decreases by one, and a number of credits shown in a bet display (as described below) increases by one.

[0037] In some embodiments, as shown in FIG. **2**B, the input device(s) **130** may include and/or interact with additional components, such as gesture sensors **156** for gesture input devices, and/or a touch-sensitive display that includes a digitizer **152** and a touchscreen controller **154** for touch input devices, as disclosed herein. The player may interact with the gaming device **100** by touching virtual buttons on one or more of the display devices **116**, **118**, **140**. Accordingly, any of the above-described input devices, such as the input device **130**, the game play initiation button **132** and/or the cashout button **134** may be provided as virtual buttons or regions on one or more of the display devices **116**, **118**, **140**.

[0038] Referring briefly to FIG. **2**B, operation of the primary display device **116**, the secondary display device **118** and the player tracking display **142** may be controlled by a video controller **30** that receives video data from a processing circuit **12** or directly from a memory device **14** and displays the video data on the display screen. The credit display **120** and the bet display **122** are typically implemented as simple liquid crystal display (LCD) or light emitting diode (LED) displays that display a number of credits available for wagering and a number of credits being wagered on a particular game. Accordingly, the credit display **120** and the bet display **122** may be driven directly by the processing circuit **12**. In some embodiments however, the credit display **120** and/or the bet display **122** may be driven by the video controller **30**.

[0039] Referring again to FIG. **2**A, the display devices **116**, **118**, **140** may include, without limitation: a cathode ray tube, a plasma display, an LCD, a display based on LEDs, a display based on a plurality of organic light-emitting diodes (OLEDs), a display based on polymer light-emitting diodes (PLEDs), a display based on a plurality of surface-conduction electron-emitters (SEDs), a display including a projected and/or reflected image, or any other suitable electronic device or display mechanism. In certain embodiments, as described above, the display devices **116**, **118**, **140** may include a touchscreen with an associated touchscreen controller **154** and digitizer **152**. The display devices **116**, **118**, **140** may be of any suitable size, shape, and/or configuration. The display devices **116**, **118**, **140** may include flat or curved display surfaces.

[0040] The display devices **116**, **118**, **140** and video controller **30** of the gaming device **100** are generally configured to display one or more game and/or non-game images, symbols, and indicia. In certain embodiments, the display devices **116**, **118**, **140** of the gaming device **100** are configured to display any suitable visual representation or exhibition of the movement of objects; dynamic lighting; video images; images of people, characters, places, things, and faces of cards; and the like. In certain embodiments, the display devices **116**, **118**, **140** of the gaming device **100** are configured to display one or more virtual reels, one or more virtual wheels, and/or one or more virtual dice. In other embodiments, certain of the displayed images, symbols, and indicia are in mechanical form. That is, in these embodiments, the display device **116**, **118**, **140** includes any electromechanical device, such as one or more rotatable wheels, one or more reels, and/or one or more dice, configured to display at least one or a plurality of game or other suitable images, symbols, or indicia.

[0041] The gaming device **100** also includes various features that enable a player to deposit credits in the gaming device **100** and withdraw credits from the gaming device **100**, such as in the form of a payout of winnings, credits, etc. For example, the gaming device **100** may include a bill/ticket dispenser **136**, a bill/ticket acceptor **128**, and a coin acceptor **126** that allows the player to deposit coins into the gaming device **100**.

[0042] As illustrated in FIG. **2**A, the gaming device **100** may also include a currency dispenser **137** that may include a note dispenser configured to dispense paper currency and/or a coin generator configured to dispense coins or tokens in a coin payout tray.

[0043] The gaming device **100** may further include one or more speakers **150** controlled by one or more sound cards **28** (FIG. **2**B). The gaming device **100** illustrated in FIG. **2**A includes a pair of speakers **150**. In other embodiments, additional speakers, such as surround sound speakers, may be provided within or on the housing **105**. Moreover, the gaming device **100** may include built-in seating with integrated headrest speakers.

[0044] In various embodiments, the gaming device **100** may generate dynamic sounds coupled with attractive multimedia images displayed on one or more of the display devices **116**, **118**, **140** to provide an audio-visual representation or to otherwise display full-motion video with sound to attract players to the gaming device **100** and/or to engage the player during gameplay. In certain embodiments, the gaming device **100** may display a sequence of audio and/or visual attraction messages during idle periods to attract potential players to the gaming device **100**. The videos may be customized to provide any appropriate information.

[0045] The gaming device **100** may further include a card reader **138** that is configured to read magnetic stripe cards, such as player loyalty/tracking cards, chip cards, and the like. In some embodiments, a player may insert an identification card into a card reader of the gaming device. In some embodiments, the identification card is a smart card having a programmed microchip or a magnetic strip coded with a player's identification, credit totals (or related data) and other relevant information. In other embodiments, a player may carry a portable device, such as a cell phone, a radio frequency identification tag or any other suitable wireless device, which communicates a player's identification, credit totals (or related data) and other relevant information to the gaming device. In some embodiments, money may be transferred to a gaming device through electronic funds transfer. When a player funds the gaming device, the processing circuit determines the amount of funds entered and displays the corresponding amount on the credit or other suitable display as described above.

[0046] In some embodiments, the gaming device **100** may include an electronic payout device or module configured to fund an electronically recordable identification card or smart card or a bank or other account via an electronic funds transfer to or from the gaming device **100**.

[0047] FIG. **2**B is a block diagram that illustrates logical and functional relationships between various components of a gaming device **100**. It should also be understood that components described in FIG. **2**B may also be used in other computing devices, as desired, such as mobile computing devices for example. As shown in FIG. **2**B, the gaming device **100** may include a processing circuit **12** that controls operations of the gaming device **100**. Although illustrated as a single processing circuit, multiple special purpose and/or general purpose processors and/or processor cores may be provided in the gaming device **100**. For example, the gaming device **100** may include one or more of a video processor, a signal processor, a sound processor and/or a communication controller that performs one or more control functions within the gaming device **100**. The processing circuit **12** may be variously referred to as a "controller," "microcontroller," "microprocessor" or simply a "computer." The processor may further include one or more application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs).

[0048] Various components of the gaming device **100** are illustrated in FIG. **2**B as being connected to the processing circuit **12**. It will be appreciated that the components may be connected to the processing circuit **12** through a system bus **151**, a communication bus and controller, such as a universal serial bus (USB) controller and USB bus, a network interface, or any other suitable type of connection.

[0049] The gaming device **100** further includes a memory device **14** that stores one or more functional modules **20**. Various functional modules **20** of the gaming device **100** will be described in more detail below in connection with FIG. **2**D.

[0050] The memory device **14** may store program code and instructions, executable by the processing circuit **12**, to control the gaming device **100**. The memory device **14** may also store other data such as image data, event data, player input data, random or pseudo-random number generators, pay-table data or information and applicable game rules that relate to the play of the gaming device. The memory device **14** may include random access memory (RAM), which can include non-volatile RAM (NVRAM), magnetic RAM (ARAM), ferroelectric RAM (FeRAM) and other forms as commonly understood in the gaming industry. In some embodiments, the memory device **14** may include read only memory (ROM). In some embodiments, the memory device **14** may include flash memory and/or EEPROM (electrically erasable programmable read only memory). Any other suitable magnetic, optical and/or semiconductor memory may operate in conjunction with the gaming device disclosed herein.

[0051] The gaming device **100** may further include a data storage **22**, such as a hard disk drive or flash memory. The data storage **22** may store program data, player data, audit trail data or any other type of data. The data storage **22** may include a detachable or removable memory device, including, but not limited to, a suitable cartridge, disk, CD ROM, Digital Video Disc ("DVD") or USB memory device.

[0052] The gaming device **100** may include a communication adapter **26** that enables the gaming device **100** to communicate with remote devices over a wired and/or wireless communication network, such as a local area network (LAN), wide area network (WAN), cellular communication network, or other data communication network. The communication adapter **26** may further include circuitry for supporting short range wireless communication protocols, such as Bluetooth and/or NFC that enable the gaming device **100** to communicate, for example, with a mobile communication device operated by a player.

[0053] The gaming device **100** may include one or more internal or external communication ports that enable the processing circuit **12** to communicate with and to operate with internal or external peripheral devices, such as eye tracking devices, position tracking devices, cameras, accelerometers, arcade sticks, bar code readers, bill validators, biometric input devices, bonus devices, button panels, card readers, coin dispensers, coin hoppers, display screens or other displays or video sources, expansion buses, information panels, keypads, lights, mass storage devices, microphones, motion sensors, motors, printers, reels, Small Computer System Interface ("SCSI") ports, solenoids, speakers, thumb drives, ticket readers, touch screens, trackballs, touchpads, wheels, and wireless communication devices. In some embodiments, internal or external peripheral devices may communicate with the processing circuit through a USB hub (not shown) connected to the processing circuit **12**.

[0054] In some embodiments, the gaming device **100** may include a sensor, such as a camera **127**, in communication with the processing circuit **12** (and possibly controlled by the processing circuit **12**) that is selectively positioned to acquire an image of a player actively using the gaming device **100** and/or the surrounding area of the gaming device **100**. In one embodiment, the camera **127** may be configured to selectively acquire still or moving (e.g., video) images and may be configured to acquire the images in either an analog, digital or other suitable format. The display devices **116**, **118**, **140** may be configured to display the image acquired by the camera **127** as well as display the visible manifestation of the game in split screen or picture-in-picture fashion. For example, the camera **127** may acquire an image of the player and the processing circuit **12** may incorporate that image into the primary and/or secondary game as a game image, symbol or indicia.

[0055] Various functional modules of that may be stored in a memory device **14** of a gaming device **100** are illustrated in FIG. **2**C. Referring to FIG. **2**C, the gaming device **100** may include in the memory device **14** a game module **20**A that includes program instructions and/or data for operating a hybrid wagering game as described herein. The gaming device **100** may further include a player tracking module **20**B, an electronic funds transfer module **20**C, an input device interface **20**D, an audit/reporting module **20**E, a communication module **20**F, an operating system kernel **20**G and a random number generator **20**H. The player tracking module **20**B keeps track of the play of a player. The electronic funds transfer module **20**C communicates with a back end server or financial institution to transfer funds to and from an account associated with the player. The input device interface **20**D interacts with input devices, such as the input device **130**, as described in more detail below. The communication module **20**F enables the gaming device **100** to communicate with remote servers and other gaming devices using various secure communication interfaces. The operating system kernel **20**G controls the overall operation of the gaming device **100**, including the loading and operation of other modules. The random number generator **20**H generates random or pseudorandom numbers for use in the operation of the hybrid games described herein.

[0056] In some embodiments, a gaming device **100** includes a personal device, such as a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a mobile device, a tablet computer or computing device, a personal digital assistant (PDA), or other portable computing devices. In some embodiments, the gaming device **100** may be operable over a wireless network, such as part of a wireless gaming system. In such embodiments, the gaming machine may be a hand-held device, a mobile device or any other suitable wireless device that enables a player to play any suitable game at a variety of different locations. It should be appreciated that a gaming device or gaming machine as disclosed herein may be a device that has obtained approval from a regulatory gaming commission or a device that has not obtained approval from a regulatory gaming commission.

[0057] For example, referring to FIG. **2**D, a gaming device **100** (which is a mobile gaming device **170** in this embodiment) may be implemented as a handheld device including a compact housing **105** on which is mounted a touchscreen display device **116** including a digitizer **152**. One or more input devices **130** may be included for providing functionality of for embodiments described herein. A camera **127** may be provided in a front face of the housing **105**. The housing **105** may include one or more speakers **150**. In the gaming device **100**, various input buttons described above, such as the cashout button, gameplay activation button, etc., may be implemented as soft buttons on the touchscreen display device **116** and/or input device **130**. In this embodiment, the input device **130** is integrated into the touchscreen display device **116**, but it should be understood that the input device may also, or alternatively, be separate from the display device **116**. Moreover, the gaming device **100** may omit certain features, such as a bill acceptor, a ticket generator, a coin acceptor or dispenser, a card reader, secondary displays, a bet display, a credit display, etc. Credits can be deposited in or transferred from the gaming device **100** electronically.

[0058] FIG. **2**E illustrates a standalone gaming device **100** (which is an EGM **160** in this embodiment) having a different form factor from the EGM **160** illustrated in FIG. **2**A. In particular, the gaming device **100** is characterized by having a large, high aspect ratio, curved primary display device **116** provided in the housing **105**, with no secondary display device. The primary display device **116** may include a digitizer **152** to allow touchscreen interaction with the primary display device **116**. The gaming device **100** may further include a player tracking display **142**, an input device **130**, a bill/ticket acceptor **128**, a card reader **138**, and a bill/ticket dispenser **136**. The gaming device **100** may further include one or more cameras **127** to enable facial recognition and/or motion tracking.

[0059] Although illustrated as certain gaming devices, such as electronic gaming machines (EGMs), mobile gaming devices, VR/AR headsets, etc., functions and/or operations as described herein may also include wagering stations that may include electronic game tables, conventional game tables including those involving cards, dice and/or roulette, and/or other wagering stations such as sports book stations, video poker games, skill-based games, virtual casino-style table games, or other casino or non-casino style games. Further, gaming devices according to embodiments herein may be implemented using other computing devices and mobile devices, such as smart phones, tablets, and/or personal computers, among others.

[0060] FIGS. **3**A-**3**C illustrate a wagering game tournament being played by a player across different devices and platforms, according to some embodiments. As shown by FIG. **3**A, an EGM **300** connected to an EGM casino network **302** includes a graphical user interface (GUI) **304** for providing a wagering game tournament that includes game elements **314** for play of a wagering game **312** including a plurality of game symbols **316**. In this example, the wagering game **312** is a slot-style game, but it should be understood that any type of wagering game may be provided in this and other tournament formats.

[0061] A first tournament entry **306** for the wagering game tournament is received via the EGM **300**, which may include play of the wagering game **312**. The GUI **304** may also include an indication of an EGM player account **308** associated with the player that is operable on the EGM casino network **302**. The GUI **304** may also include an indication of a combined player account **310** associated with the player and linking the EGM player account **308** to other accounts associated with the player on other platforms.

[0062] As shown by FIG. **3**B, a second tournament entry **326** for the wagering game tournament is received via a Video Lottery Terminal (VLT) device **320** on a VLT lottery network **322** separate from the EGM casino network **302**. It should also be understood that while the second tournament entry **326** is received via a VLT device **320** in this example, other devices, networks, and/or channels may be used, such as a personal and/or mobile computing device on an Internet-connected network, for example.

[0063] The second tournament entry **326** may include continued play of the wagering game **312** (or another wagering game, as desired), on a GUI **324** of the VLT device **320**. In this example, receipt of the second tournament entry **326** may be enabled only after receipt of the first tournament entry **306**, i.e., with the second tournament entry **326** at the VLT device **320** being unlocked by play of the wagering game **312** at the EGM **300**, for example. The GUI **324** may also include an indication of VLT player account **328** associated with the player that is operable on the VLT lottery network **302**, and may also include an indication of the combined player account **310** associated with the player and linking the VLT player account **328** to other accounts associated with the player on other platforms, such as the EGM player account **308** for example. In this example, the combined player account is associated with a combined player account system that is separate from the EGM casino network **302** and the VLT lottery network **322**.

[0064] As shown by FIG. **3**C, a game result **330** for the wagering game tournament is determined based on the first tournament entry **306** and the second tournament entry **326**. An indication of the game result **330** is provided via a GUI of a device being accessed by the player (the GUI **324** of the VLT device **320** in this example), but it should be understood that any network connected device may provide an indication of the game result **330**, as desired. In response to the game result **330** being a winning game result, a game award **332** may be provided to the associated player.

[0065] In another example, multiple players can participate in a tournament across different channels, such as in a "relay"-style tournament. In this regard, FIGS. **4**A and **4**B illustrate a wagering game tournament being played by different players across different devices and platforms, according to some embodiments. As shown by FIG. **4**A, an EGM **400** connected to an EGM casino network **402** includes a graphical user interface (GUI) **404** for providing a wagering game tournament that includes game elements **414** for play of a wagering game **412** including a plurality of game symbols **416**. A first tournament entry **406** for the wagering game tournament is received via the EGM **400**, which may include play of the wagering game **412** by a first player. The GUI **404** may also include an indication of an EGM player account **408** associated with the first player that is operable on the EGM casino network **402** and may also include an indication of a combined player account **410** associated with the first player and linking the EGM player account **408** to other accounts associated with the first player on other platforms. The GUI **403** may also include an indication of combined player accounts associated with other players participating in the tournament, including a combined player account **411** associated with a second player playing on a device in a different channel.

[0066] In this regard, FIG. **4**B illustrates a second tournament entry **426** for the wagering game tournament being received via a mobile computing device **440** on Internet-connected network **442** separate from the EGM casino network **402**. The GUI **424** includes an indication of another wagering game **413** and may also include an indication of a mobile player account **448** associated with the second player playing the wagering game **413** as part of the tournament. The mobile player account **448** is operable on Internet-connected network **442** and the GUI **444** may also include an indication of the combined player account **411** associated with the second player and linking the mobile player account **448** to other accounts associated with the second player on other platforms. The GUI **403** may also include an indication **450** of combined player accounts associated with other players participating in the tournament, including the combined player account **410** associated with the first player playing on the EGM **400**.

[0067] FIG. **5** is a flowchart illustrating operations **500** of systems/methods for facilitating embodiments described herein. The operations **500** may be performed by one or more processor circuits of one or more computing devices, such as any of the computing devices described herein, for example. The operations **500** may include receiving, by a processor circuit, a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network (Block **502**). The operations **500** may further include receiving, by the processor circuit, a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network (Block **504**). The operations **500** may further include determining, by the processor circuit, a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry. (Block **506**). The operations **500** may further include, in response to the game result being a winning game result, providing, by the processor circuit, a game award to a player associated with the winning game result (Block **508**).

[0068] Embodiments described herein may be implemented in various configurations for gaming devices **100**, including but not limited to: (1) a dedicated gaming device, wherein the computerized instructions for controlling any games (which are provided by the gaming device) are provided with the gaming device prior to delivery to a gaming establishment; and (2) a changeable gaming device, where the computerized instructions for controlling any games (which are provided by the gaming device) are downloadable to the gaming device through a data network when the gaming device is in a gaming establishment. In some embodiments, the computerized instructions for controlling any games are executed by at least one central server, central controller or remote host. In such a "thin client" embodiment, the central server remotely controls any games (or other suitable interfaces), and the gaming device is utilized to display such games (or suitable interfaces) and receive one or more inputs or commands from a player. In another embodiment, the computerized instructions for controlling any games are communicated from the central server, central controller or remote host to a gaming device local processor and memory devices. In such a "thick client" embodiment, the gaming device local processor executes the communicated computerized instructions to control any games (or other suitable interfaces) provided to a player.

[0069] In some embodiments, a gaming device may be operated by a mobile device, such as a mobile telephone, tablet or other mobile computing device. For example, a mobile device may be communicatively coupled to a gaming device and may include a user interface that receives user inputs that are received to control the gaming device. The user inputs may be received by the gaming device via the mobile device.

[0070] In some embodiments, one or more gaming devices in a gaming system may be thin client gaming devices and one or more gaming devices in the gaming system may be thick client gaming devices. In another embodiment, certain functions of the gaming device are implemented in a thin client environment and certain other functions of the gaming device are implemented in a thick client environment. In one such embodiment, computerized instructions for controlling any primary games are communicated from the central server to the gaming device in a thick client configuration and computerized instructions for controlling any secondary games or bonus functions are executed by a central server in a thin client configuration.

[0071] The present disclosure contemplates a variety of different gaming systems each having one or more of a plurality of different features, attributes, or characteristics. It should be appreciated that a "gaming system" as used herein refers to various configurations of: (a) one or more central servers, central controllers, or remote hosts; (b) one or more gaming devices; and/or (c) one or more personal gaming devices, such as desktop computers, laptop computers, tablet computers or computing devices, PDAs, mobile telephones such as smart phones, and other mobile computing devices.

[0072] In certain such embodiments, computerized instructions for controlling any games (such as any primary or base games and/or any secondary or bonus games) displayed by the gaming device are executed by the central server, central controller, or remote host. In such "thin client" embodiments, the central server, central controller, or remote host remotely controls any games (or other suitable interfaces) displayed by the gaming device, and the gaming device is utilized to display such games (or suitable interfaces) and to receive one or more inputs or commands. In other such embodiments, computerized instructions for controlling any games displayed by the gaming device are communicated from the central server, central controller, or remote host to the gaming device and are stored in at least one memory device of the gaming device. In such "thick client" embodiments, the at least one processor of the gaming device executes the computerized instructions to control any games (or other suitable interfaces) displayed by the gaming device.

[0073] In some embodiments in which the gaming system includes: (a) a gaming device configured to communicate with a central server, central controller, or remote host through a data network; and/or (b) a plurality of gaming devices configured to communicate with one another through a data network, the data network is an internet or an intranet. In certain such embodiments, an internet browser of the gaming device is usable to access an internet game page from any location where an internet connection is available. In one such embodiment, after the internet game page is accessed, the central server, central controller, or remote host identifies a player prior to enabling that player to place any wagers on any plays of any wagering games. In one example, the central server, central controller, or remote host identifies the player by requiring a player account of the player to be logged into via an input of a unique username and password combination assigned to the player. It should be appreciated, however, that the central server, central controller, or remote host may identify the player in any other suitable manner, such as by validating a player tracking identification number associated with the player; by reading a player tracking card or other smart card inserted into a card reader (as described below); by validating a unique player identification number associated with the player by the central server, central controller, or remote host; or by identifying the gaming device, such as by identifying the MAC address or the IP address of the internet facilitator. In various embodiments, once the central server, central controller, or remote host identifies the player, the central server, central controller, or remote host enables placement of one or more wagers on one or more plays of one or more primary or base games and/or one or more secondary or bonus games, and displays those plays via the internet browser of the gaming device.

[0074] It should be appreciated that the central server, central controller, or remote host and the gaming device are configured to connect to the data network or remote communications link in any suitable manner. In various embodiments, such a connection is accomplished via: a conventional phone line or other data transmission line, a digital subscriber line (DSL), a T-1 line, a coaxial cable, a fiber optic cable, a wireless or wired routing device, a mobile communications network connection (such as a cellular network or mobile internet network), or any other suitable medium. It should be appreciated that the expansion in the quantity of computing devices and the quantity and speed of internet connections in recent years increases opportunities for players to use a variety of gaming devices to play games from an ever-increasing quantity of remote sites. It should also be appreciated that the enhanced bandwidth of digital wireless communications may render such technology suitable for some or all communications, particularly if such communications are encrypted. Higher data transmission speeds may be useful for enhancing the sophistication and response of the display and interaction with players.

[0075] In the above description of various embodiments, various aspects may be illustrated and described herein in any of a number of patentable classes or contexts including any new and useful process, machine, manufacture, or composition of matter, or any new and useful improvement thereof. Accordingly, various embodiments described herein may be implemented entirely by hardware, entirely by software (including firmware, resident software, microcode, etc.) or by combining software and hardware implementation that may all generally be referred to herein as a "circuit," "module," "component," or "system." Furthermore, various embodiments described herein may take the form of a computer program product including one or more computer readable media having computer readable program code embodied thereon.

[0076] Any combination of one or more computer readable media may be used. The computer readable media may be a computer readable signal medium or a computer readable storage medium. A computer readable storage medium may be, for example, but not limited to, an electronic, magnetic, optical, electromagnetic, or semiconductor system, apparatus, or device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. More specific examples (a non-exhaustive list) of the computer readable storage medium would include the following: a portable computer diskette, a hard disk, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), an appropriate optical fiber with a repeater, a portable compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. In the context of this document, a computer readable storage medium may be any medium that can contain, or store a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

[0077] A computer readable signal medium may include a propagated data signal with computer readable program code embodied therein, for example, in baseband or as part of a carrier wave. Such a propagated signal may take any of a variety of forms, including, but not limited to, electromagnetic, optical, or any suitable combination thereof. A computer readable signal medium may be any computer readable medium that is not a computer readable storage medium and that can communicate, propagate, or transport a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device. Program code embodied on a computer readable signal medium may be transmitted using any appropriate medium, including but not limited to wireless, wireline, optical fiber cable, radio frequency ("RF"), etc., or any suitable combination of the foregoing.

[0078] Computer program code for carrying out operations for aspects of the present disclosure may be written in any combination of one or more programming languages, including an object oriented programming language such as Java, Scala, Smalltalk, Eiffel, JADE, Emerald, C++, C#, VB.NET, Python or the like, conventional procedural programming languages, such as the "C" programming language, Visual Basic, Fortran 2003, Perl, Common Business Oriented Language ("COBOL") 2002, PHP: Hypertext Processor ("PHP"), Advanced Business Application Programming ("ABAP"), dynamic programming languages such as Python, Ruby and Groovy, or other programming languages. The program code may execute entirely on the user's computer, partly on the user's computer, as a stand-alone software package, partly on the user's computer and partly on a remote computer or entirely on the remote computer or server. In the latter scenario, the remote computer may be connected to the user's computer through any type of network, including a local area network (LAN) or a wide area network (WAN), or the connection may be made to an external computer (for example, through the Internet using an Internet Service Provider) or in a cloud computing environment or offered as a service such as a Software as a Service (Saas).

[0079] Various embodiments were described herein with reference to flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams of methods, apparatus (systems), devices and computer program products according to various embodiments described herein. It will be understood that each block of the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, and combinations of blocks in the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, can be implemented by computer program instructions. These computer program instructions may be provided to a processing circuit of a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or other programmable data processing apparatus to produce a machine, such that the instructions, which execute via the processing circuit of the computer or other programmable instruction execution apparatus, create a mechanism for implementing the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

[0080] These computer program instructions may also be stored in a computer readable medium that when executed can direct a computer, other programmable data processing apparatus, or other devices to function in a particular manner, such that the instructions when stored in the computer readable medium produce an article of manufacture including instructions which when executed, cause a computer to implement the function/act specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks. The computer program instructions may also be loaded onto a computer, other programmable instruction execution apparatus, or other devices to cause a series of operations to be performed on the computer, other programmable apparatuses or other devices to produce a computer implemented process such that the instructions which execute on the computer or other programmable apparatus provide processes for implementing the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

[0081] The flowchart and block diagrams in the figures illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of possible implementations of systems, methods, and computer program products according to various aspects of the present disclosure. In this regard, each block in the flowchart or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of code, which includes one or more executable instructions for implementing the specified logical function (s). It should also be noted that, in some alternative implementations, the functions noted in the block may occur out of the order noted in the figures. For example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be executed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, can be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts, or combinations of special purpose hardware and computer instructions.

[0082] The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular aspects only and is not intended to be limiting of the disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms "a", "an" and "the" are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms "comprises" and/or "comprising," when used in this specification, specify the presence of stated features, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof. As used herein, the term "and/or" includes any and all combinations of one or more of the associated listed items and may be designated as "/". Like reference numbers signify like elements throughout the description of the figures.

[0083] Many different embodiments have been disclosed herein, in connection with the above description and the drawings. It will be understood that it would be unduly repetitious and obfuscating to literally describe and illustrate every combination and subcombination of these embodiments. Accordingly, all embodiments can be combined in any way and/or combination, and the present specification, including the drawings, shall be construed to constitute a complete written description of all combinations and subcombinations of the embodiments described herein, and of the manner and process of making and using them, and shall support claims to any such combination or subcombination.

What is claimed is:

1. A system comprising:

a processor circuit; and

a memory coupled to the processor circuit, the memory comprising machine-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor circuit, cause the processor circuit to:

receive a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network;

receive a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network;

determine a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry; and

in response to the game result being a winning game result, provide a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

2. The system of claim **1**, wherein the first tournament entry is associated with a first player and wherein the second tournament entry is associated with the first player.

3. The system of claim **2**, wherein receipt of the second tournament entry enabled only after receipt of the first tournament entry.

4. The system of claim **1**, wherein the first tournament entry is associated with a first player and wherein the second tournament entry is associated with a second player.

5. The system of claim **1**, wherein the first plurality of gaming devices on the first gaming network is a plurality of electronic gaming machines (EGMs) on an EGM casino network, and

wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network are located outside the EGM casino network.

6. The system of claim **5**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of computing devices on an Internet-connected network.

7. The system of claim **5**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of video lottery terminals (VLTs) on a VLT lottery network.

8. The system of claim **1**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of video lottery terminals (VLTs) on a VLT lottery network, and

wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network are located outside the VLT lottery network.

9. The system of claim **8**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of computing devices on an Internet-connected network.

10. The system of claim **8**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of electronic gaming machines (EGMs) on an EGM casino network.

11. The system of claim **1**, wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network is a plurality of computing devices on an Internet-connected network, and

wherein the second plurality of gaming devices on the second gaming network are located outside the Internet-connected network.

12. The system of claim **11**, wherein the plurality of computing devices comprises a plurality of mobile computing devices.

13. The system of claim **1**, wherein the first tournament entry is associated with a first player account on a first player account system, and

wherein the second tournament entry is associated with a second player account on a second player account system different from the first player account system.

14. The system of claim **13**, wherein the first player account is associated with a first combined account on a third combined player account system, and

wherein the second player account is associated with a second combined account on the third combined player account system.

15. A system comprising:

a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network;

a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network;

a processor circuit; and

a memory coupled to the processor circuit, the memory comprising machine-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor circuit, cause the processor circuit to:

receive a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of the first plurality of gaming devices;

receive a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of the second plurality of gaming devices;

determine a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry; and

in response to the game result being a winning game result, provide a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

16. The system of claim **15**, wherein the first tournament entry is associated with a first player and wherein the second tournament entry is associated with the first player.

17. The system of claim **16**, wherein receipt of the second tournament entry is enabled only after receipt of the first tournament entry.

18. The system of claim **17**, wherein the first tournament entry is associated with a first player and wherein the second tournament entry is associated with a second player.

19. A method comprising:

receiving, by a processor circuit, a first tournament entry for a wagering game tournament from a first gaming device of a first plurality of gaming devices on a first gaming network;

receiving, by the processor circuit, a second tournament entry for the wagering game tournament from a second gaming device of a second plurality of gaming devices on a second gaming network different from the first gaming network;

determining, by the processor circuit, a game result for the wagering game tournament based on the first tournament entry and the second tournament entry; and

in response to the game result being a winning game result, providing, by the processor circuit, a game award to a player associated with the winning game result.

20. The method of claim **19**, wherein receipt of the second tournament entry is enabled only after receipt of the first tournament entry.

* * * * *